



INDIAN LAW & DEALMAKING · 17 AUGUST 2026

Five moves shaping the board now.

- › SC Halts Rahul Gandhi HC Inquiry
- › SC Pulls Up FSSAI On Labels
- › Tribunals Reforms Bill Passed
- › SC Quashes Biyani Protection
- › SC Orders Manipur Special Courts

SWIPE →



SUPREME COURT · CRIMINAL & CONSTITUTIONAL

01 / 05

Supreme Court Halts High Court Asset Probe

On August 17, 2026, a Supreme Court bench headed by Chief Justice Surya Kant halted Allahabad High Court proceedings and CBI and ED inquiries into disproportionate asset allegations against Lok Sabha opposition leader Rahul Gandhi. The court held that constitutional courts must strictly observe principles of natural justice before directing investigative agencies.

THE READ

This ruling reins in judicial overreach by high courts initiating fishing expeditions without affording accused parties a proper hearing. Practitioners must leverage this precedent to challenge unreasoned investigative directions.



Supreme Court Warns FSSAI Over Warning Labels

On August 13, 2026, the Supreme Court reprimanded the Food Safety and Standards Authority of India for delaying mandatory front-of-pack warning labels for foods high in sugar, salt, and fat. The bench warned that it would issue direct judicial mandates if the regulator failed to comply within two weeks.

THE READ

The judiciary is increasingly intolerant of regulatory foot-dragging on public health compliance. Food sector companies must proactively overhaul packaging strategies to align with stringent warning requirements.



Lok Sabha Passes Tribunals Reforms Bill

On August 10, 2026, the Lok Sabha successfully passed the Tribunals Reforms Bill, introducing structural changes to streamline adjudicatory bodies and harmonize appellate frameworks. The legislation aims to reduce pendency and rationalize qualifications and tenure for tribunal members across sectors.

THE READ

This statute reshapes institutional dispute resolution by centralizing administrative oversight. Corporate counsel must review jurisdictional alignments for ongoing tribunal proceedings under the updated framework.



Supreme Court Quashes Sunil Biyani Interim Protection

On August 12, 2026, the Supreme Court set aside a Bombay High Court order that had granted interim protection from coercive action to businessman Sunil Biyani. The apex court restored strict accountability on commercial defaulters challenging enforcement measures.

THE READ

High courts granting blanket interim relief in commercial disputes face mounting judicial scrutiny from the apex court. Creditors can use this stance to aggressively pursue recovery actions without intermediate appellate hurdles.



SUPREME COURT · CRIMINAL JUSTICE

05 / 05

Supreme Court Directs Special Courts For Manipur

On August 10, 2026, the Supreme Court mandated the establishment of two dedicated special courts to expedite criminal trials arising from communal violence in Manipur. The directive seeks to ensure time-bound judicial processing and victim redressal.

THE READ

Specialized judicial infrastructure highlights the apex court direct management of localized trial backlogs. Litigants involved in sensitive regional matters can expect accelerated timelines and stricter docket control.



THE THROUGH-LINE

Recent judicial interventions this week demonstrate an assertive Supreme Court aggressively checking both high court procedural overreach and administrative delays. Across criminal probes, regulatory enforcement, and institutional reforms, the judiciary is demanding strict adherence to natural justice and statutory timelines. For elite practitioners, navigating this climate requires anticipating heightened judicial impatience with dilatory tactics and regulatory laxity alike.





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